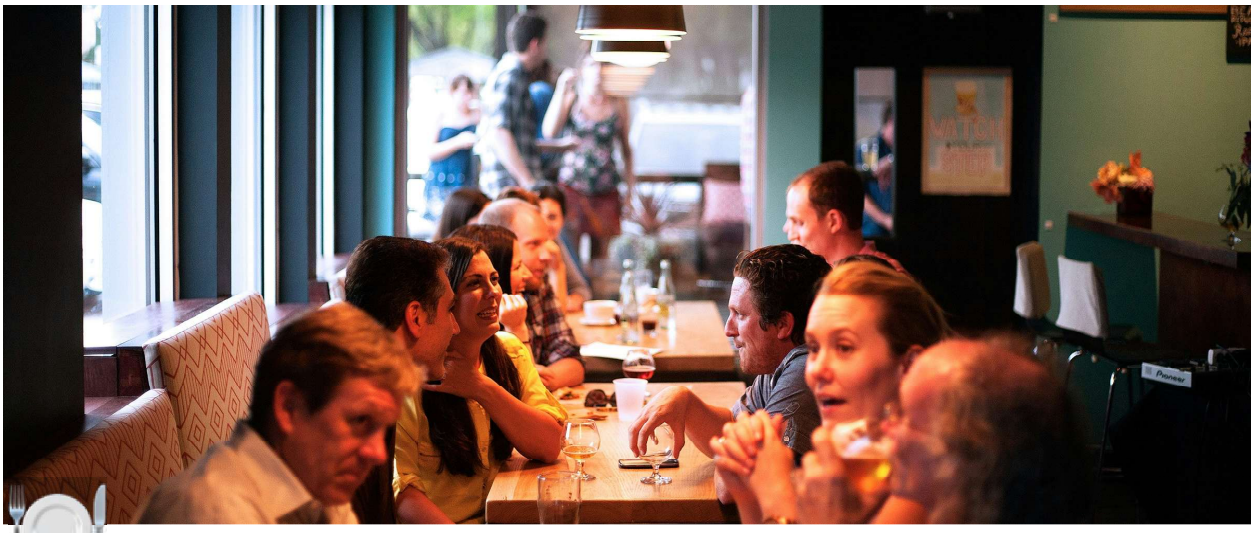

Product Design

📌 **Problem Statement**

Design an app for reducing waiting time in restaurants

Why Solve This? 💡

Reducing waiting time in restaurants directly improves the dining experience, as long wait times often lead to customer frustration, dissatisfaction, and lower customer retention rates. An app that minimizes wait times can enhance customer satisfaction by offering better visibility of waitlist status, engaging ways to pass the time, and personalized service options, leading to:

1. **Enhanced Customer Experience**: With real-time updates and estimated wait times, customers feel more informed and in control, significantly reducing perceived wait time stress.
2. **Increased Customer Retention & Loyalty**: A positive, streamlined experience encourages customers to return and recommend the restaurant, fostering loyalty.
3. **Higher Revenue for Restaurants**: By improving table turnover and optimizing seating, restaurants can serve more guests efficiently, potentially increasing revenue during peak hours.
4. **Differentiated Competitive Advantage**: As customers increasingly expect convenience, a tailored wait-time management app can position a restaurant as a modern, customer-centric choice in a competitive market.

By addressing the waiting experience, we can not only improve in-restaurant satisfaction but also contribute to a restaurant's long-term success and customer loyalty.

I'll begin with a few clarifying questions to narrow down our scope, making sure we're addressing the most impactful aspects of the waiting experience in restaurants.

1. Clarifying Questions

▼ Are we focusing on reducing wait times for a specific part of the dining experience, such as waiting to be seated, ordering, or waiting for the bill?

Focus on Comprehensive Wait Reduction

We'll address multiple wait times in the restaurant experience—waiting to be seated, ordering, and paying—since these collectively contribute to the overall customer satisfaction and efficiency in table turnover.

▼ Are we designing this solution for specific types of restaurants (e.g., casual dining, fast food, fine dining) or for all types?

Target Audience - Casual Dining

The app will primarily cater to casual dining and mid-range restaurants, where table turnover and efficient seating are important for revenue, but where advanced reservation systems may not always be in place.

▼ Should the solution be focused on a particular geography or market, where dining culture and waiting dynamics might differ, or is it meant to be globally adaptable?

Location - Urban Centers

The app will initially focus on urban areas with higher density dining, where wait times are more common due to peak-hour demand, increasing the potential impact of a wait-reduction solution.

▼ Will this app need to integrate with restaurant management systems, or are we building it as a stand-alone solution? For instance, integration could allow us to access table status or order tracking data.

Integration with POS and Reservation Systems

To improve functionality, the app should integrate with restaurant POS and reservation systems to receive real-time updates on table status and menu changes, enhancing the flow and transparency of information for both customers and staff.

▼ Will this app serve both customers and restaurant staff (waiters, hosts, kitchen), or should it focus solely on the customer side?

Dual User Base (Customers and Staff)

Both customers and restaurant staff will use the app. Customers will use it for real-time updates on wait status, menu selection, and ordering, while staff can access seating and order statuses to manage the restaurant flow more efficiently.

▼ Should we design this app to work with reservation platforms (like OpenTable or Zomato) or payment platforms?

Coordination with Reservation and Payment Platforms

The app will link to existing reservation and payment platforms for seamless table booking, order placement, and payments, aiming to streamline each step from arrival to departure.

▼ Are there specific metrics or goals that we should prioritize? For instance, reducing total wait time by a certain percentage, improving customer satisfaction scores, or increasing table turnover rate?

Metrics for Success - Reduced Waiting Time and Higher Table Turnover

Success will be measured by decreased customer wait times, improved customer satisfaction scores, and increased table turnover rate, all of which signal a smoother and more efficient dining experience.

▼ Are there particular gaps in existing apps we should focus on? For instance, do current solutions lack real-time updates, or is there a need for better communication between customers and staff?

Gap in the Market - Lack of Real-time Communication:

Current solutions may not provide real-time feedback on each stage of the dining experience or facilitate direct communication between customers and staff. This app will aim to fill that gap, allowing customers to receive updates on their wait time, order progress, and payment status.

▼ Are there any budget or time constraints that we are dealing with here?

Timeline - 3-4 Months to Launch. No Budget Constraints

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2. Product Definition

Product Vision

To create a seamless dining experience by minimizing wait times and improving real-time communication between customers and restaurant staff. This app will reduce idle times and enhance transparency at each stage of the dining process, ultimately elevating customer satisfaction and operational efficiency for restaurants.

Product Scope

The app will streamline three main stages of a customer's dining journey—seating, ordering, and payment—targeting urban casual dining restaurants where customer flow and table turnover are critical.

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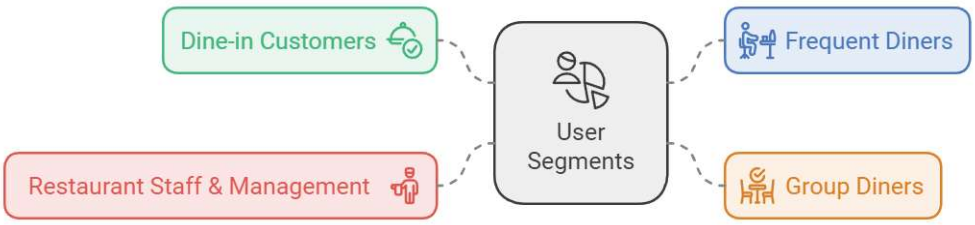
3. User Segmentation

Based on the use cases identified, here are the primary user segments likely to benefit from a wait-time reduction app:



User Segment	Description	Frequency of Use	Goal	Pain Points
Dine-in Customers (Casual Diners)	Individuals or small groups, primarily interested in a smooth and efficient dining experience.	Moderate, typically weekends or evenings.	Reduce idle time and improve the overall dining experience.	Unpredictable wait times, limited table availability, and long waits for order processing.
Frequent Diners	Regular customers, often part of loyalty programs or those who frequently dine at specific locations. (Often visiting their favorite places)	High; may visit 1-2 times weekly.	Quick and predictable dining experience with minimal wait.	Frustration with unanticipated delays, particularly at busy times.
Large Group Diners	Large groups or families who may require more seating arrangements and coordinated ordering.	Occasional; generally weekends or holidays.	Coordinate arrival times and seating availability.	Difficulty in getting seating for large groups, long wait times, and slower order processing.
Restaurant Staff & Management	Hosts, waitstaff, and managers who aim to provide seamless customer service.	Daily.	Streamline seat management, reduce bottlenecks in order processing, and enhance table turnover rates.	Limited visibility on customer flow, delays in seating management, and inefficient communication

User Segment	Description	Frequency of Use	Goal	Pain Points
				across service touchpoints.

📌 **Let's get to prioritizing one of these segments, to further narrow down the scope of our task.**

The **Dine-in Customers (*Casual Diners*)** will be the prioritized segment.

They are likely to provide the **largest impact**, given their primary goal is a smooth and efficient experience, and they **represent a significant portion** of urban restaurant visitors. Solving their pain points could improve *satisfaction rates* and also *boost table turnover* for the restaurant. As we are designing a new product, it is advised that we choose what specific user category to cater to.

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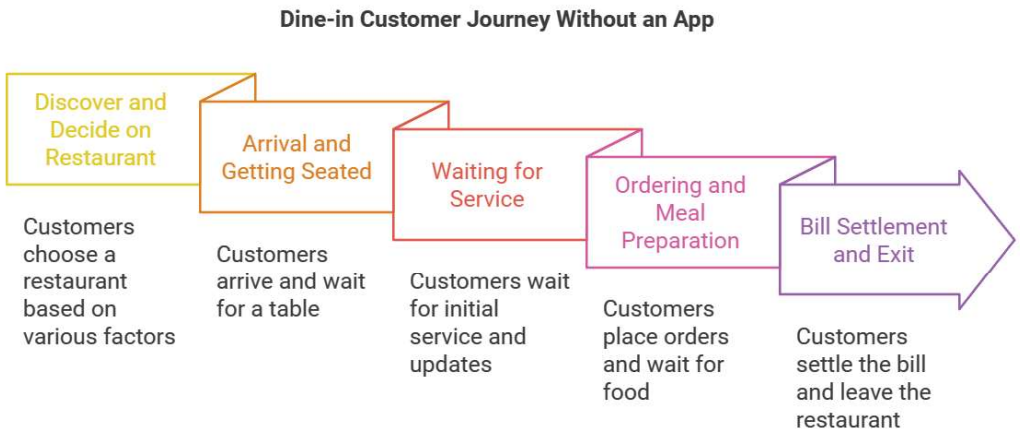
4. User Journey for Casual Diners (without an app)

Let's break down the experience of dine-in customers in a typical urban setting without an app designed to streamline wait times and seating coordination.



1. **Pre-Arrival: Discovering and Deciding on a Restaurant**
   - Customers decide where to dine based on factors like cuisine, location, and reviews. Typically, this involves checking online listings, google reviews or using maps for popular places.
2. **Arrival: Getting Seated**
   - Upon arriving, customers must join the line or wait at the host station for table availability.
3. **Waiting for Service**

- After being seated, diners await menu delivery, initial order taking, and food arrival.

4. **Ordering and Meal Preparation**
   - Customers review the menu, place their orders, and wait for food.
5. **Post-Meal: Bill Settlement and Exit**
   - After the meal, customers request the bill, pay, and leave.

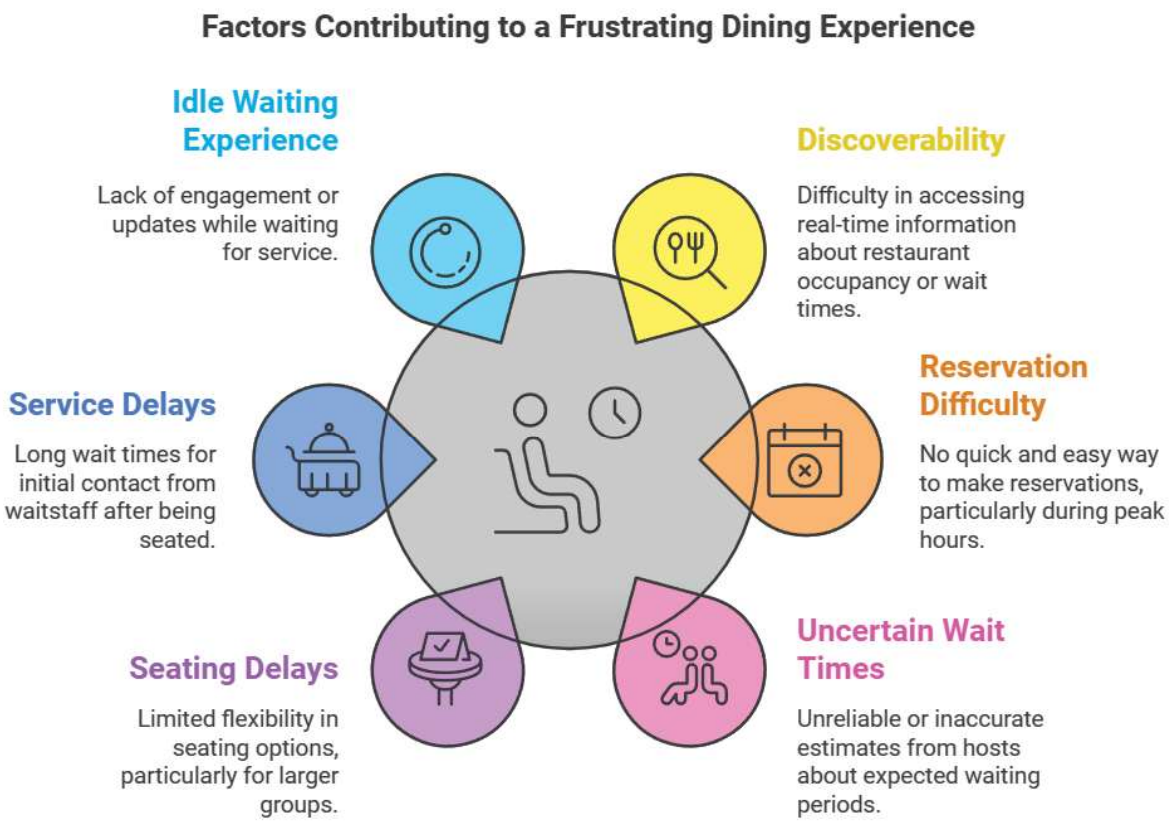
Challenges faced in this Pre-Product Journey

This journey highlights multiple pain points, notably:

1. The lack of real-time wait estimates,
2. Unpredictable service speed, and
3. Poor visibility on order status.

These factors contribute to dissatisfaction, impacting both the customer's experience and the restaurant’s turnover efficiency.

5. Pain Points - User Problems



1. Pre-Arrival Challenges

- **Discoverability**: Difficulty in accessing real-time information about restaurant occupancy or wait times.
- **Reservation Difficulty**: No quick and easy way to make reservations, particularly during peak hours.

2. Arrival and Seating Issues

- **Uncertain Wait Times**: Unreliable or inaccurate estimates from hosts about expected waiting periods.
- **Seating Delays**: Limited flexibility in seating options, particularly for larger groups, which can increase wait times.

3. Waiting for Initial Service

- **Service Delays**: Long wait times for initial contact from waitstaff after being seated.
- **Idle Waiting Experience**: Lack of engagement or updates while waiting for service, leading to impatience and frustration.

4. Ordering and Meal Preparation Transparency

- **Order Taking Delay**: Slow response time from staff when taking orders, particularly during busy hours.
- **Order Status Visibility**: Minimal or no information provided about order status or estimated time to completion.

5. Billing and Payment Experience

- **Payment Delays**: Slow bill processing, which can prolong the time spent waiting to leave.
- **Limited Payment Flexibility**: Lack of options for contactless payment, quick pay, or split bills, especially for groups.

6. Potential Solutions - Features in the app

1. Real-Time Occupancy Tracker

This feature solves the problem of diners arriving at fully booked restaurants without prior knowledge of seat availability. It will be implemented by partnering with casual dining restaurants, where Wi-Fi counters or sensors track the number of occupied seats. This data, alongside predictive analytics (considering day, time, and historical occupancy trends), will

give diners a clear picture of crowd levels, so they can plan accordingly. This information will be visible to users in-app, showing each restaurant's real-time capacity and estimated wait times based on current occupancy.

- **Features:**
  - Real-time occupancy display, visual map with occupancy indicators for each restaurant
  - Peak hours indicator with recommendations on the best times to visit.
  - Location-based tracker to show nearby restaurants with available seating.
- **Impact:** Customers gain a clear sense of restaurant capacity before visiting, reducing the frustration
  - Empowers users to plan better, reducing unexpected waiting times.
  - Improves restaurant footfall management, particularly during off-peak times.
  - Increases customer satisfaction by providing visibility on seating availability.
- **Hygiene Check**:
  Regularly compare sensor data with actual seating numbers to ensure data accuracy, and set alerts for significant deviations in occupancy predictions to prompt timely adjustments.

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2. Reservation Optimization with Adaptive Time Slots

For casual dining, where fixed time slots can be challenging due to unpredictable wait times, this feature allows flexible booking based on real-time capacity and party size. Adaptive time slots are dynamically created by analyzing past reservation patterns, group sizes, and the day's trend data. Users will be able to book specific time slots that adjust in real-time, accommodating fluctuations in restaurant capacity.

- **Features:**
  - Time slot adjustments according to predicted customer flow.
  - Smart capacity management that limits reservations during peak times.
  - Notifications for users when their preferred time slots open up.
- **Impact:** Customers experience less waiting and more reliable reservations.
  - Increases restaurant seating efficiency, reducing bottlenecks.
  - Helps users secure reservations with realistic wait expectations.
  - Reduces overcrowding during peak hours, enhancing dining experience quality.
- **Hygiene Check**:
  Track no-show rates and overbooked slots to improve prediction accuracy. Set automated

alerts for staff if seating demand exceeds capacity, prompting real-time adjustments.

---

3. Smart Waitlist with Digital Check-In

In this feature, casual diners can join a digital waitlist when all tables are occupied. Once on the waitlist, users get real-time queue updates and can even check in remotely. Using GPS or location services, diners receive a notification when it's their turn, allowing them to remain nearby instead of waiting in the restaurant lobby.

- **Features:**
  - Digital queue management with real-time position updates.
  - Push notifications when the table is nearly ready.
  - Option for group members to check in individually and be notified as a group.
- **Impact:** Reduces the physical waiting time in the restaurant, enhancing convenience.
  - Reduces idle wait time in the restaurant, leading to a better customer experience.
  - Helps staff manage incoming guests more efficiently.
  - Increases user convenience and engagement by enabling remote check-ins.
- **Hygiene Check**:
  Monitor waitlist drop-off rates and set a maximum capacity to avoid an overly crowded waitlist. A/B test notification timings to balance engagement with a non-intrusive experience.

---

4. Automated Check-In and Pre-Ordering

This feature lets customers pre-order their meals and automatically check in when they arrive. Casual diners can browse the menu in-app and select items before reaching the restaurant. Geofencing or Bluetooth technology detects their arrival, triggering an automated check-in and notifying the kitchen to start order preparation. This helps streamline the dining experience by syncing food readiness with the diner's arrival.

- **Features:**
  - Access to the digital menu with a pre-order option
  - Automatic check-in upon arrival to notify kitchen and staff
  - Real-time sync with kitchen for precise meal timing
- **Impact:** Shortens wait time at the table, as orders are ready sooner after seating.
  - Reduces wait time for order-taking, allowing for faster service.
  - Improves kitchen efficiency by allowing pre-preparation during slow times.

    - Enhances the overall dining experience by making the start of service smoother.
- **Hygiene Check**:
  Track the accuracy of automated check-ins vs. manual arrival times to refine geofencing. Set alerts for delays in order preparation if orders remain in “hold” status too long, ensuring fresh and timely delivery.

---

5. Order Progress Tracker

Alleviates anxiety around order status by providing users with real-time updates on their meal's preparation stage. An order progress tracker shows diners each stage of their meal’s preparation, from “Order Placed” to “Ready for Service” and “On the Way to Table.” Casual diners can see each update as kitchen staff adjust order statuses, giving them a real-time sense of when their food will arrive.

- **Features:**
    - Visual order tracker showing stages like "preparing," "cooking," and "ready."
    - Notifications at each stage, allowing diners to anticipate serving time.
    - Feedback option for users to report issues or delays.
- **Impact:**
    - Reduces customer anxiety, especially during peak hours.
    - Provides transparency, enhancing trust in restaurant service.
    - Gives users more control over their dining experience, improving satisfaction.
- **Hygiene Check**:
  Monitor discrepancies between actual and estimated delivery times, identifying bottlenecks. Implement quality control checks if delays consistently occur at any stage in the process.

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6. Interactive Wait Experience

This feature provides entertainment and menu previews for diners waiting for their table. Casual diners can explore the menu, including daily specials, nutritional information, and chef recommendations, while also engaging in restaurant-specific quizzes, trivia, or other light games that align with the dining venue’s vibe.

- **Features**:
    - Interactive, real-time menu exploration
    - Engaging trivia and quiz content related to the restaurant and the food ordered.
    - Notifications on wait progress, updated at regular intervals

- **Impact**:
  Enhances the waiting experience by reducing perceived wait times, making the wait feel shorter and more enjoyable, and providing value through interactive content.
- **Hygiene Check**:
  Track user engagement metrics to identify popular content and adjust games or menu previews accordingly. Regularly refresh content based on engagement metrics to keep it interesting.

---

7. Instant Bill Checkout

This feature lets diners check out digitally from their table without waiting for staff. After dining, customers can view an itemized bill in the app, pay through various digital payment options, and even split the bill if dining in groups. The app generates a digital receipt post-payment, along with an option for feedback.

- **Features:**
  - Digital billing with itemized receipts and the option to tip.
  - Multiple payment methods, including digital wallets and credit cards.
  - Feedback prompt post-payment for continuous service improvement.
- **Impact:** Reduces wait time during checkout, making it convenient for customers to leave at their own pace without delays, especially during busy times.
  - Speeds up the exit process, freeing tables for new customers.
  - Improves operational efficiency by reducing server workload.
  - Provides a seamless, contactless payment option that enhances convenience.
- **Hygiene Check**:
  Track failed or incomplete transactions to identify issues. Run monthly audits on submitted feedback to identify patterns and improve service quality.

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8. Group Payment Options

This feature allows friends or family to split bills seamlessly. Each diner selects the items they're responsible for, and the app calculates individual totals. Each diner can then pay their share directly from the app, with options for various payment methods. Once all payments are completed, the restaurant staff is notified automatically. (similar alternative - Integration with Splitwise)

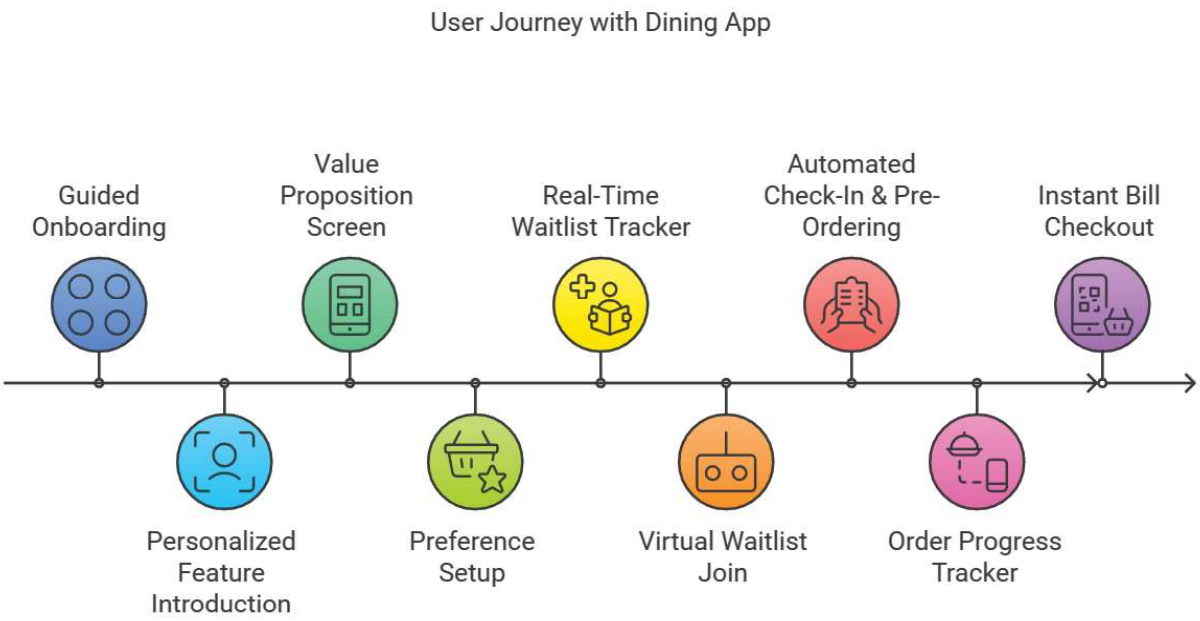
- **Features:**
  - Bill-splitting option, potential integration with apps such as Splitwise.
  - Multiple payment options for individual payers.
  - Notifications to the restaurant once the full bill is settled.
- **Impact:** Simplifies bill-splitting for group diners, eliminating the need for manual calculations and ensuring a smooth end to the dining experience.
  - Enhances the group dining experience, reducing payment-related stress.
  - Shortens the payment time for groups, improving table turnover.
  - Offers added flexibility for diners, making group outings easier to organize.
- **Hygiene Check**:
  Track successful group payments and user satisfaction rates to refine the feature. Address failed transactions promptly and provide in-app support to resolve billing issues efficiently.

Problem Solution Mapping & Prioritization

User Stage	Pain Point	Solution	MoSCoW	Rationale
Discovery	Difficulty knowing restaurant occupancy before visiting	Real-Time Occupancy Tracker	**Must Have**	Key to minimizing diner frustration and reducing walk-ins during peak times. This transparency builds user trust and reduces no-shows by keeping customers informed about wait times.
Booking	Inflexible reservation times due to variable wait times	Reservation Optimization with Adaptive Time Slots	**Should Have**	Useful for enhancing user convenience, especially on busy days. Adaptive time slots increase reservation accuracy by aligning with real-time seat availability, directly impacting booking success rates and user satisfaction.
Waiting	Frustration with long wait times upon arrival	Smart Waitlist with Digital Check-In	**Must Have**	Essential for reducing physical waiting in the restaurant, giving users flexibility to wait nearby. This solution provides visibility and convenience, enhancing

User Stage	Pain Point	Solution	MoSCoW	Rationale
				the overall customer experience.
Pre-Dining	Delays in taking orders upon arrival	Automated Check-In and Pre-Ordering	**Should Have**	Improves efficiency by allowing diners to pre-order before arrival, reducing wait time at the table. Aligning orders with arrival time also optimizes kitchen workflow and reduces perceived wait time for diners.
Waiting	Boredom and frustration during prolonged wait times	Interactive Wait Experience	**Won't Have**	Enhances the waiting experience, making it more enjoyable through entertainment, while also providing menu previews. Reduces perceived wait time and keeps customers engaged.
Dining	Lack of visibility into order status	Order Progress Tracker	**Should Have**	Increases customer satisfaction by providing real-time updates on their meal's status, reducing anxiety around order wait times. Adds transparency, which is valuable in enhancing the overall dining experience.
Checkout	Waiting for bill payment, especially during busy hours	Instant Bill Checkout	**Must Have**	Highly valuable for reducing wait times, improving table turnover during peak times, and enhancing the experience by allowing customers to leave at their own pace.
Checkout	Difficulty in splitting bills among groups	Group Payment Options	**Could Have**	Adds convenience for group diners, especially in casual dining. It addresses a common pain point around bill-splitting and encourages repeat visits among friends or family dining together. Also considering the factor that integration with third-party apps like Splitwise is possible.

7. User Experience Flow (Ideal/Happy User Flow)



Onboarding Solutions

1. **Guided Onboarding**

   Imagine you just downloaded the app and opened it for the first time. A little guide, almost like a mini-tour, pops up to show you the app's most important features.

   - **How it Works**: Right when you open the app, a few screens appear with short explanations. They show you where to find features like “Check Wait Times” and “Join a Waitlist.” You simply tap to move to the next screen until you’re ready to start.
   - **Why It Helps**: This tour saves you time from exploring on your own and shows you where to find what you need right away.

2. **Personalized Feature Introduction**

   Rather than showing you everything right away, this feature gradually introduces new tools over time, based on what you need most.

   - **How it Works**: If you frequently check the waitlist for a favorite restaurant, the app highlights more advanced waitlist features, like setting up notifications. Instead of showing everything at once, it “unlocks” features as you need them.
   - **Why It Helps**: It prevents the app from feeling overwhelming by focusing on what’s most useful to you, making your experience more enjoyable.

3. **Value Proposition Screen**

The app gives a quick summary of its biggest benefits, like helping you save time by checking waitlists before you go out.

- **How it Works**: Right after you install the app, you see a screen that tells you what the app can do, such as showing real-time wait times and letting you join a waitlist. This is done with big, simple images and short, clear phrases.
- **Why It Helps**: It makes it clear why the app is useful, helping you understand why you'll want to use it.

Activation Solutions

1. **Preference Setup:**

Right after signing up, you're invited to pick your favorite restaurants and dining preferences.

- **How it Works**: During your first few minutes with the app, it asks if you have any favorite restaurants. You can tap to select your favorites, or the types of food you enjoy most, like Italian, Chinese, or Vegetarian. This way, the app can recommend places you'd love.
- **Why It Helps**: This makes sure the app shows you places and options that match your taste right from the beginning.

Waitlist Usage Solutions

1. **Real-Time Waitlist and Occupancy Tracker**

   You can see how busy a restaurant is and how long you'd have to wait if you went there now.

   - **How it Works**: Each restaurant page in the app has a clock icon, showing the current wait time. If it's 20 minutes, for example, you can decide to wait or pick another spot with a shorter wait.
   - **Why It Helps**: You don't have to guess how crowded a place will be. This information lets you decide where to eat, saving you from waiting too long.

2. **Virtual Waitlist Join Option**

   This feature lets you "line up" for a table at a restaurant without physically being there.

   - **How it Works**: If a restaurant has a long wait time, you can tap a button to join the waitlist from home or while doing other things. The app will update you on your spot in line, so you know when it's almost your turn.
   - **Why It Helps**: Instead of waiting at the restaurant, you can go about your day and head to the restaurant only when you're closer to the front of the line.

Pre-Order Solution

1. **Automated Check-In & Pre-Ordering:**

Before you get to the restaurant, you can let them know you're coming and even order food in advance.

- **How it Works**: When you join the waitlist, the app asks if you'd like to check in ahead. You can also pick food from the menu that you want to order. This means your food is already being prepared by the time you're seated.
- **Why It Helps**: This shortens the wait after you sit down, meaning you'll get your food sooner and can spend more time enjoying the meal.

In-Restaurant Solution

1. **Order Progress Tracker:**

While you're waiting at your table, you can see where your order is in the process.

- **How it Works**: After you place an order, the app shows a progress bar for each item, like "Preparing," "Cooking," and "Almost Ready." You can check this anytime to see how much longer your food might take.
- **Why It Helps**: Knowing how long the wait is makes the process feel more predictable, reducing the frustration of wondering when your food will arrive.

Payment Solutions

1. **Instant Bill Checkout with Group Payment Options:**

When it's time to pay, you can split the bill with friends or pay directly through the app.

- **How it Works**: When the meal is over, you can see your bill on the app. If you're with a group, each person can pick what they ordered and pay their share directly. This makes paying fast and simple.
- **Why It Helps**: It removes the hassle of splitting bills or waiting for the server, helping you leave the restaurant sooner without any fuss.

Retention Solution

1. **Push Notifications for Favorites and Wait Times:**

The app notifies you when a favorite restaurant has a shorter wait or has a special deal.

- **How it Works**: If you save a restaurant as a favorite, you can get updates when their wait times are short or if they have any special offers.
- **Why It Helps**: It keeps you connected to the app and helps you choose the best times to visit places you enjoy, making your dining experience smoother and more convenient.

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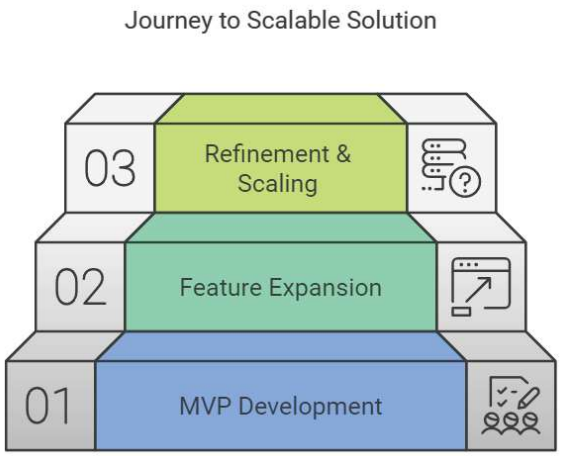
8. Success Metrics

To measure the success of the restaurant wait-time reduction app, we'll track metrics that align with each stage of the user journey. Here are some key metrics:

Metric Type	Metric & Units	Small Description	Frequency of Measuring	Baseline	Target
Onboarding	User Completion Rate of Onboarding (%)	Measures users who complete onboarding	Weekly	70%	85%
	Day-1 Retention Rate (%)	Percentage of users returning the day after onboarding	Weekly	40%	55%
Activation	Preferences Setup Completion Rate (%)	Measures users who complete preference setup during activation	Weekly	60%	75%
	Activation Rate (%)	New users who join a waitlist/check wait time in the first week	Weekly	50%	65%
Usage & Engagement	Average Waitlist Joins Per User	Average frequency of waitlist joins per user	Monthly	2 per month	4 per month
	Real-Time Waitlist Feature Usage (%)	Users checking real-time wait times	Monthly	30% of users	50% of users
	Average Time Saved (minutes)	Average time saved by checking waitlists or joining virtually	Monthly	5 minutes	15 minutes
Conversion & Monetization	In-App Payment Usage Rate (%)	Users who opt to pay via app	Monthly	15%	35%

Metric Type	Metric & Units	Small Description	Frequency of Measuring	Baseline	Target
	Bill Splitting Feature Usage (%)	Percentage of groups using the split-bill feature	Monthly	10%	30%
Retention	Monthly Active Users (MAU)	Users engaging with the app each month	Monthly	20,000 MAU	30,000 MAU
	Push Notification Engagement Rate (%)	Users engaging with notifications for wait-time updates	Monthly	15%	25%
Counter Metrics / Hygiene Checks	Drop-Off Rate During Onboarding (%)	Measures if users leave during onboarding due to information overload	Weekly	-	<5%
	App Uninstall Rate (%)	Monitors uninstalls to track potential user frustration	Monthly	7%	<5%
	Response Time of Real-Time Waitlist Data (seconds)	Tracks data refresh speed to prevent frustration	Monthly	-	<5 seconds

9. Timelines, Milestones & Strategy



For building this app from scratch, let's break down the phases into three primary development stages:

1. **Phase 1: MVP Development**
2. **Phase 2: Feature Expansion & Optimization**
3. **Phase 3: Refinement & Scaling**.

Each phase has specific timelines, milestones, and deliverables that ensure the app's core functionality is developed, tested, and improved based on user feedback.

Phase 1: MVP Development (3 Months)

Goal: Create a functional minimum viable product (MVP) to validate core features and test the primary user experience in reducing wait times.

Timeline	Milestones	Deliverables
Week 1-2	**Requirement Gathering**	User research insights, pain points, initial personas
Week 3-4	**Define Scope & App Architecture**	Functional requirements, technical architecture, UX flowcharts
Month 1-2	**Design & Core Development**	UI/UX design mockups, database schema, API development
Month 2-3	**MVP Testing & QA**	MVP build with core features (waitlist joins, real-time tracking)
End of Month 3	**MVP Launch**	Soft launch with core features for early adopters

Key MVP Features: User onboarding, waitlist join functionality, real-time waitlist data, table status updates.

Phase 2: Feature Expansion & Optimization (3-4 Months)

Goal: Add essential features, improve functionality, and refine based on initial user feedback from the MVP stage.

Timeline	Milestones	Deliverables
Week 1-2	**Collect User Feedback**	Feedback reports, prioritized improvement areas
Month 1-2	**Feature Addition**	In-app payment, customizable notifications, gamified rewards for waitlist usage
Month 2-3	**Optimization of Core Features**	Enhanced UX, optimized real-time updates, reduced response times
Month 3-4	**QA & User Acceptance Testing (UAT)**	Improved version with additional features, UAT feedback
End of Month 4	**Full Launch**	Release with core features and new functionality

Key Features Added: In-app payments, notifications for table readiness, limited booking options, gamification to reduce wait perception.

Phase 3: Refinement & Scaling (2-3 Months)

Goal: Refine existing features, optimize the app for scaling, and introduce advanced features to enhance user engagement and retention.

Timeline	Milestones	Deliverables
Week 1-2	**User Data Analysis & Iteration**	Usage analytics, key areas for feature refinement
Month 1	**Advanced Feature Addition**	Loyalty rewards, customizable user profiles
Month 2-3	**Scalability Enhancements & Final QA**	App performance optimization, reduced loading times
End of Month 3	**Wider Market Rollout**	App readiness for larger market, improved infrastructure
Ongoing	**Post-Launch Monitoring & Support**	Regular updates, feedback collection, and troubleshooting

Key Final Features: Loyalty programs, user profiles, enhanced scalability features, app monitoring for continuous improvement.

Overall Timeline and Milestones Summary

- **Months 1-3**: **Phase 1 – MVP Development**
- **Months 4-7**: **Phase 2 – Feature Expansion & Optimization**
- **Months 8-10**: **Phase 3 – Refinement & Scaling**